



1Tap Quick Bar for Android

1Tap Quick Bar is a very helpful app for Android users to customize their notifications settings
<http://dgit.in/SmG3Qf>

Creating fake screenshots

Fake FB screenshots featuring famous personalities are going viral. Find out how you can make yours
<http://dgit.in/TYQE3D>

labelled "I", which takes you to an information screen, where you scroll down to the ISO option and then switch the values. Same thing with the Sony. None of the entry level DSLRs have weather sealing, which is a little disappointing, but that's a given at this price point.

Performance

This is where things get exciting and a little tricky. When shooting outdoors, the 650D had the most pleasing colors of all, along with a very good contrast, numbers which are shared by the D5100 and the D3200 alike. The Alpha A57 was a pinch lower in the contrast department, but at par with the competition when it came to low light performance. Interestingly, due to a higher pixel count, the D3200 did show for the most detail-rich images. This we noticed even in the studio tests, where the D3200 surpassed all others in detail retention in the toy fibers and the bottle label.

Sharpness and detail is often a result of how well the

camera sensor and the lens play together. Putting a crappy lens on a great sensor will get you the same results as putting a premium lens on a crappy sensor: BAD. Therefore, we used the standard 50mm primes to evaluate sharpness and detail resolution in our studio test. We used a stuffed teddy bear along with two books placed at different corners to gauge the sensor resolution. Also featured in our test shot is a page with intricate patterns, which also helps in gauging details. Here, the D3200 outshone all its competitors, with the Canon a somewhat distant second.

We shot off the cameras on their native ISOs (no expansion tested as all of them developed significant noise at their highest native ISO) under tungsten lighting (white balanced accordingly). While the initial three ISO stops (200, 400 and 800) yielded pretty much similar image quality (great!), its at ISOs higher than 1600 where we started seeing changes in the image quality. At ISO 1600, the D3200 showed slightly more



Canon 5D MarkIII

chroma and luminance noise than its competitors, probably because of the large number of pixels packed into an APS-C sensor. ISO 3200 managed to get all the cameras, causing a stark dip in image quality. The Nikons topped out at ISO 6400, yielding images that we considered unusable, while the 650D and the Alpha 57 managed to crawl up to ISO 12800, where they stopped producing useable images.

The video performance on all the DSLRs was at par, when recorded in broad daylight at 1080p. In low light, the Canon seemed to develop chroma noise much quicker than the Sony and Nikons. The audio on all four cameras was decent when there wasn't a lot of ambient noise, however, Canon and Sony both sport stereo-mics as against the mono-mics on the Nikons, allowing for a more 'realistic' audio experience.

Verdict

The winner for our **Best Buy** category here is the **Canon 650D**. While the 650D does offer many new, innovative (and effective)

features, it is also the most expensive of the lot. The price of the 650D treads well into the territory of the 60D, Canon's semi-professional DSLR. Besides, the overall scores of our tests put the Nikons barely a few points behind and given their significantly lower price point, they could be a much better alternative. The Sony Alpha 57 does lack in high ISO performance, and has a slightly lower contrast rendition than the rest, however, it boasts of a burst speed of 12 frames per second, something that no other entry level camera in our test even comes close to. The video on all of them is at par for good lighting conditions, but in low light, the Nikons shine bright, especially if you are using a prime lens with a fast aperture.

Semi-Pro DSLRs

While the current focus seems to be on adding more and more versatile entry-level DSLRs, the serious hobbyist photographer isn't left hanging. These cameras come with better frame rates, an intelligent focusing system with a higher number



Sony Alpha SLT-77